Chinese argument was that India and China have several other mechanisms for cooperation and that China treated the SCO as its domain to pursue its exclusive goals.

However, 2014 proved to be a pivotal year. In March that year, President Xi Jinping reportedly stated to the Indian envoy to China that he looked at consolidating a strategic partnership with India as his historical mission.[13] At the 4th Conference on Interaction and Confidence Building Measures in Asia (CICA) in Shanghai on 21 May, Xi articulated China's new "Asian security concept"[14] and that China would "pro-actively" seek to build a regional framework. Expectations were aroused in India that it now figured high in Xi Jinping's calculus. China's push towards closer relations with India came in the face of its increased tensions with Vietnam and US allies the Philippines and Japan over its more assertive claims to maritime territory. China also sought to build fresh bridges to prevent India's new leadership teaming up with the US "Asia Pivot" strategy. Another reason was China's increasingly restive Xinjiang province. Xi Jinping therefore tried to seek broader regional cooperation to deal with the spread of terrorism and wanted closer cooperation with India in Central Asia.

Furthermore, Russia attempted to rebalance its strategic interests in Asia in the face of its standoff with the United States and the EU over the Ukraine crisis developing in 2014. In doing this, Russia wanted to strengthen the CSTO and expand the SCO.[15] Finally, India's new Prime Minister Narendra Modi invited Pakistan's Prime Minister to his swearing-in ceremony on 26 May 2014. From the SCO's point of view, this invitation would have a positive impact towards removing the negative factor in Indo–Pakistani relations that had thus far obstructed the expansion plan of the SCO.

At the SCO Summit in Dushanbe in September 2014, India's External Affairs Minister Sushma Swaraj submitted a